



NATO

North Atlantic
Treaty Organization

Agenda: Assessing Member
States' Defence Spending
amid Escalating Global Threats

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Agenda: Assessing Member States' Defence Spending Amid Escalating Global Threats

COMMITTEE OVERVIEW

The North American Treaty Organisation (NATO) is an intergovernmental military alliance that was established in 1949 to provide collective security against the Soviet Union. NATO is a strategic security alliance of 32 nations across Europe and North America. The primary objective of NATO's establishment is to foster the security and freedom of Allied states through military and strategic cooperation. After World War II, Europe was acutely divided, as conflicts between the Soviet Union and Western democracies escalated and since the Cold War was about to begin, countries in Europe, along with the US, Canada, and others, worked to team up and establish a joint agreement to prevent future Soviet aggression. This led to the official establishment of NATO, when the North Atlantic Treaty was signed in Washington, D.C. The alliance originally included 12 founding members: Belgium, Canada, Denmark, France, Iceland, Italy, Luxembourg, the Netherlands, Norway, Portugal, the United Kingdom, and the United States.

The watchword for NATO has always been that an attack against one member state would be perceived as an attack against all the member states, and collective actions would be required to restore and preserve security. NATO with its 32 member nations fosters military co-action, intel sharing and most importantly crisis response. NATO's aim has always been to strengthen all the members and then have a united and integrated approach to tackle and materialize emerging global threats.

INTRODUCTION

In the times of rising and intensifying geopolitical tensions, NATO's capability to

uphold defence and suppression is being heavily tested by a rapidly growing security landscape.

Cyber warfare and rising military assertiveness globally have made strategic defence investments to become highly relevant to secure national interests.

NATO's 2% GDP defence spending conditional guideline set to ensure satisfactory military preparedness, has been a topic of argument, as disparities in contributions raise immense concerns about burden sharing, logistical effectiveness and the consortium's long-term sustainability. A few of the member states struggle to meet the threshold due to economic constraints or various other national priorities, which then lead to gaps in strategic susceptibility. At the same time, emerging technologies like autonomous weaponry and cyber capabilities require excessive investment in modern defence systems. These discussions will evaluate the adequacy of current defence budgets in understanding these evolving threats, the risks of under-subsidized funding and potential policy measures to significantly enhance collective security. Delegates must understand and weigh in the economic realities of defence expenditure against NATO's strategic obligations, and prospect various mechanisms to ensure financial commitments to incline with the alliance's long-term objectives, especially security as a whole. The outcome of having this agenda in the debate will result in having specific recommendations for fortifying NATO's repression posture in an increasingly volatile global order.

DEFENCE SPENDING

NATO—since the early 1950s—defines defence spending in a prevalent way that is uniformly agreed upon by all the NATO allies and is constantly critiqued every year cardinally. It is defined as the payments made by a national

government (excluding regional, local and municipal authorities) specifically to meet the needs of its armed forces, those of Allies or of the Alliance. The primary components of the defence spending incorporate armed forces including land, maritime and air forces as well as joint formations. Moreover, it also comprises other combatants such as the interior troops, national police forces, and coast guards. Furthermore, there are various components like retirement pensions, war reserves, operations and missions, and most importantly Research and Development (R&D).¹

Past Defence Spending

In the post-Cold War era, the harsh consequences of the Cold War between the United States and the Soviet Union—from 1947 to 1991—led to a drastic decline in the defence expenditure of the Western countries. The USA's expenditure hit the lowest from 6 percent of their Gross Domestic Product (GDP) in 1989 to 3 percent approximately a decade later. And as a ripple effect, the European countries struck even lower. In 2006, NATO embarked on the journey to pledge to attain the target for defence spending of 2 percent of each confederate's GDP.²

However, due to global conflicts and uncertainty in political situations, this pledge was not aptly implemented. Austerity policies drove a decline in military spending in most of the European Region in 2012. The 2008 financial crisis—Great Recession—caused circumstances so radical that

18 of the 31 countries in the European NATO cut off more than 10 percent of their defence spending.

With every downfall comes an uprise, which was observed in Eastern Europe as they rose from it by showing an increment of 15.3 percent in 2012—marking the largest regional increase. Similarly, Russia and Ukraine boosted their military spending by 24 per cent to strengthen the defences between the two contending nations.³

In the case of the USA, the defence spending peaked in 2010 at 964.4 billion US Dollars, moderately as a consequence of the involvement of the spiralling military situations in the Middle East. The uprising of the Budget Control Act of 2011 brought about the decline in the defence budget in 2012 as it focused on limiting budgets—including military spending—to help neutralise the surging national deficit.⁴

Current Defence Spending

The 2014 Defence Investment Pledge established the agreement of all the NATO Heads of State and Government to commit 2 percent of their national GDP to defence spending. This commitment safeguards stability and ensures national protection while assuring the Alliance's military readiness. The agreement made in 2006 by the NATO defence ministers serves as a precursor to this pledge. Russia's illegal annexation of Crimea, amid border instability in the Middle East and a separatist war in the

¹Nato. (2023, July 11). Defence expenditures and NATO's 2% guideline. NATO. https://www.nato.int/cps/en/natohq/topics_49198.htm/

²The Economist Newspaper. (n.d.). NATO defence spending is rising, but not fast enough. The Economist. <https://www.economist.com/graphic-detail/2023/07/12/nato-defence-spending-is-rising-but-not-fast-enough/>

³World military spending falls, but China, Russia's spending rises, says SIPRI. (n.d.). SIPRI. <https://www.sipri.org/media/press-release/2013/world-military-spending-falls-china-russias-spending-rises-says-sipri>

⁴USAFacts. (2024, August 1). How much does the US spend on the military? <https://usafacts.org/articles/how-much-does-the-us-spend-on-the-military/>

Donbas, acted as a catalyst, reaffirming this agreement to be firmly established and attained by the year 2024. The 2% commitment highlights the desire for each nation in the alliance to contribute to the colossal defence efforts while preserving individuality and sovereignty.

The strong and growing emphasis on defence foresees that 23 allies will be expected to achieve and outpace this target, compared to only three allies in the year 2014—the USA, the United Kingdom (UK) and Greece.⁵ In accordance with this, over the past decade, European Allies and Canada have deliberately shown a steady upsurge in their cumulative investment in defence. The accumulated GDP rose from 1.43 per cent in 2014 to 2.02 per cent in 2024, with an investment of 485 billion US Dollars. The USA stands as the front-runner in terms of the substantial contribution of approximately 967 billion US Dollars.⁶

Additionally, there is a separate 20 per cent of defence expenditure—stipulated by the NATO allies—reserved for major new and modern equipment with the inclusion of R&D as it is perceived as an essential component to modernise and comprehend the technology leading to the long-term effectiveness of the NATO defence.

IMPACTS

International Influence

NATO member's defence spending plays a very crucial role in battling armed threats, but the inconsistencies in military budgets have majorly

impacted the alliance's overall preparedness. Russia's constant belligerence in Ukraine has forced Eastern European NATO members, like Poland and the Baltic states, to accelerate military modernization and develop weaponization as a concept. The increasing investments in tanks, air defence systems, and troop deployments have been at their peak. However, nations failing to meet the basic guideline of the 2% GDP terms in defence spending have weakened the collective suppression, which has placed a heavier burden on frontline states and the U.S. China's military expansion and growing tensions in the Indo-Pacific have also forced NATO to enhance its naval and aerial capabilities. While the alliance primarily operates in the Atlantic region focussed around Euro, the rising security challenges in the South China Sea entail greater investment in expeditious-response forces and long-range defence systems.⁷ With extensive focus on hybrid warfare tactics which include drone strikes, and disinformation campaigns, have created new susceptibility that require advanced technological defence spending. The unevenness in military consciousness affects NATO's ability to respond effectively to direct armed conflicts. Under spending in key areas like logistics, and troop mobilization could delay military responses in much-needed situations. To counter evolving threats, NATO members must ensure consistent investment in armed forces,

⁵Reuben, A. (2024, July 10). How much do NATO members spend on defence?. BBC News. <https://www.bbc.com/news/world-44717074>

⁶Defence expenditure of NATO countries (2014-2024). (n.d.). https://www.nato.int/nato_static_fl2014/assets/pdf/2024/6/pdf/240617-def-exp-2024-en.pdf

⁷Team, E. (2024, July 6). Analyzing the defence budget and its impact on international relations - total military insight. The Insurance Universe. <https://totalmilitaryinsight.com/defence-budget-and-international-relations/>

maintaining the alliance's reliability and operational strength.⁸

Global Security

NATO's irregular division in defence spending impacts global security and infects the alliance's ability to counter the threats. Poland and the Baltic states have been investing significantly in defence and hence bracing up NATO's eastern flank, further improving their suppression against Russian aggression. The over-dependence on the U.S military power for reinforcement highlighted the risk of extra strategic dependency, which the States claims would potentially weaken NATO's long-term sturdiness. The rising arms threats including the military expansion of China and Ukraine's military expansion ask for the requirement of a more simplified yet cohesive NATO strategy. Increasing defence spending is very crucial for strengthening the emergency response forces as a whole. The imbalance in defence investments could lead to the reduction in belief of NATO's trustworthiness and increase the likelihood of local conflicts. It has been observed that if the member states fail to grade, rank and order the format of defence spending in key zones, NATO's ability to safeguard global security would weaken significantly— something only possible to maintain through sustained military investments.⁹ Sustained investments for minimizing defence gaps and increased military

coordination are key to maintain stability in a volatile landscape.

FACTORS AFFECTING DEFENCE SPENDING

Global Conflicts

World military expenditure rose for the ninth consecutive year to an all-time high of \$2443 billion. This has been observed across all the countries across the globe, particularly in Europe and Oceania. The past two years of war have significantly changed the security perspective of NATO states. They believe that prioritising military strength is of utmost importance due to the constant threats posed by these wars. This global deterioration of peace and security has forced them to direct large percent of their GDPs towards military spending.¹⁰ This bears the risk of an action-reaction spiral in an already volatile geopolitical situation. This war in Ukraine has prompted an 18% increase in defence spending this year among NATO allies across Europe and Canada. The NATO target of 2% defence spending is now being seen as a baseline to maintain rather than a threshold to reach.¹¹

This increase is to provide support to Ukraine's war effort and to meet their own armed requirements and stocks. Ukraine is in immense need of artillery ammunition production so special efforts have been made in that section. The war in Russia has exposed the lack of

⁸Trump's five percent doctrine and NATO defence spending. (n.d.-a). <https://www.piie.com/blogs/realtime-economics/2025/trumps-five-percent-doctrine-and-nato-defense-spending>

⁹McInnis, K., Fata, D., Jensen, B., & III, J. M. M. (n.d.). *Pulling their weight: The data on NATO responsibility sharing*. CSIS. https://www.csis.org/analysis/pulling-their-weight-data-nato-responsibility-sharing?utm_source=chatgpt.com

¹⁰Nato. (2023, July 11). *Funding NATO*. NATO. https://www.nato.int/cps/uk/natohq/topics_67655.htm?selectedLocale=en&utm_

¹¹Sbusch. (2024, July 8). *Who's at 2 percent? look how NATO allies have increased their defence spending since Russia's invasion of Ukraine*. Atlantic Council. <https://www.atlanticcouncil.org/blogs/econographics/whos-at-2-percent-look-how-nato-allies-have-increased-their-defense-spending-since-russias-invasion-of-ukraine/>

inventory in many NATO states.¹² Advanced production technologies have been put in place to improve the defence industry so military requirements can be fulfilled at the earliest.

The war in Gaza has also been a major contributor towards this cause. The looming fears of region-wide conflict has been a growing concern. Combined with the rapidly changing diplomatic relations with Israel and other Arab countries has urged many to significantly work towards developed military production.¹³

Outdated Military Technology

The EU and its Member States are spending €14.4 billion annually on military R&D compared to €130 billion in the US, ten times more.¹⁴ Even in this amount, each state has different priorities hence carrying out solitary work. There is very little cooperation amongst the states causing major defence production to be carried out on a national need basis. This has made a very small, fragmented defence industry in the EU hindering new innovation. Often new military technologies have emerged from items of commercial use.

Increasing funding towards innovation and encouraging collaboration between defence companies and research institutes could contribute towards beneficial technological advancements in the EU. Joint ventures to

improve R&D are essential steps towards advancements in military tech. This can be achieved by increasing public funding and unifying capital markets to invest in this cause. As the markets are mainly dominated by national companies working only for the domestic audience, there is a need for international cooperation so that progress can be achieved at a large scale at a much faster rate. The fragmentation also causes interoperability of equipment so a uniform standard formation is needed. Emerging technologies like artificial intelligence, autonomous systems, biotech and quantum technologies are crucial to be explored. NATO allies have pledged to cooperate with the defence industry to maintain their technological edge by agreeing that at least 20% of defence expenditures should be devoted to spending on major new equipment, including the associated R&D.¹⁵

Strategic Autonomy

The rising military conflicts have shown NATO states the need to increase defence spending. However, the fragmented defence market in Europe prevents them from developing at the necessary rate. This is rising competition for energy and chemicals and difficulties in getting approvals. Many European states heavily rely on China for certain materials which has proved to be difficult in recent times. The EU aims for

¹²The military balance 2025: Defence spending and procurement trends. (n.d.). <https://www.iiss.org/publications/the-military-balance/2025/defence-spending-and-procurement-trends/>

¹³Global military spending surges amid war, rising tensions and insecurity. SIPRI. (2024, April 22). <https://www.sipri.org/media/press-release/2024/global-military-spending-surges-amid-war-rising-tensions-and-insecurity>

¹⁴Defence Technologies - time to think big again. EEAS. (n.d.). https://www.eeas.europa.eu/eeas/defence-technologies-time-think-big-again_en

¹⁵Nato. (2025, February 12). NATO's role in defence industry production. NATO. https://www.nato.int/cps/en/natohq/topics_222589.htm#:~:text=Maintaining%20NATO%27s%20technological%20edge,-At%20the%202014&text=As%20part%20of%20this%20Pledge,reflect%20the%20Alliance%27s%20democratic%20values

member states' total annual production capacity to reach two million rounds by the end of 2025.¹⁶ Currently, more than three-quarters of the defence imports by EU states are from outside the EU, with the USA being the top exporter having a 63 percent share. It is believed that buying from the USA is faster and more predictable than relying on the European defence industry and to maintain U.S. interest in European security. But this is often more expensive.

The European Commission has envisioned a strategy to ensure that by 2030 at least 50 percent of the procurement costs go to EU-based suppliers only and it should also be a result of collaborative effort. There is a need to identify projects of common interest which can be worked upon and produced together in Europe. These projects could fill capability gaps in integrated European air and missile defence, space domain awareness, cyber defence, or maritime and underwater protection. All these efforts aim to reduce dependence on external states for any arms trade.

National Interests

Observations indicate that domestic political dynamics and institutional interests significantly shape national defence spending policies. While promising to provide the best for the citizens, these groups pursue policies or models that add to their benefits without acknowledging the consequences. Voters have less power in these decisions and the armed forces that partake in these decisions can be corrupted by the contractors. Bureaucracies in the form of the

Defence Ministry and the Armed Forces have been observed to focus their goals on maximising the budget and ensuring its success by overestimating the threat and underestimating the costs of their chosen policies and their decided defence equipment.

Aside from these facts, it can be also perceived that each nation has its own set of concerns associated with the national beliefs as well as the relationships or dynamics between the member states. This creates a setback in curating a specialised NATO like an economically efficient NATO based on role specialisation by comparative advantage.¹⁷

TRANSPARENCY

One of the most important goals of NATO is to ensure adequate transparency of how defence expenditure is being utilised by every nation—something even more relevant when we consider the integrated and collective defensive plan aims of the NATO countries. Despite aims, country spending reports are largely based on the honour system with NATO collecting periodic data from allies and publishing the same.¹⁸ As a result, whether the funding was efficient, practical, or even if it took place can sometimes be opaque, despite seemingly transparent records.

While this is not currently the case, pressuring nations to deliver more can result in false declarations and raise the question of how personal assurances can be quantified, verified, and how collective measures can be streamlined. The voluntary nature of the spending commitments does help provide more accurate

¹⁶{"@type": "Person", "name": "Sophia Besch"}. (n.d.). *Understanding the EU's new Defense Industrial Strategy*. Carnegie Endowment for International Peace. <https://carnegieendowment.org/posts/2024/03/understanding-the-eus-new-defense-industrial-strategy?lang=en>

¹⁷NATO and the economic and financial crisis. (n.d.-b). https://www.files.ethz.ch/isn/108881/rp_52.pdf

¹⁸ North Atlantic Treaty Organisation – Organisation du Traité de l'Atlantique Nord. (2024). *Defence Expenditure of NATO countries (2014-2024)*. In North Atlantic Treaty Organisation – Organisation Du Traité De L'Atlantique Nord.

results to a degree. A core current debate centres on whether the EU should develop 'strategic autonomy', and if so, whether this should be carried out independently of NATO or as a European pillar within the alliance.¹⁹ This raises a question of whether it is in the EU's best interests to be transparent about their defence capabilities despite the nature of the NATO agreement from a strategic point of view. One of the primary challenges for this agenda will remain ensuring EU nations and non-EU nations can align interests and maintain collective defence plans while also ensuring their national goals are secured.

CASE STUDIES

Ukraine-Russia Conflict

Background

The protests in Ukraine in late 2013 and early 2014 resulted in Ukraine's Parliament impeaching President Yanukovich on 22 February 2014. A few days later, dozens of pro-Russian gunmen besieged multiple government offices and buildings in Crimea and raised the Russian flag. Many international leaders accused Russia of planning a "military invasion and occupation" as armed men took over two airports in Crimea. This led to a referendum on joining Russia, which was backed by 95% voters. However, this referendum was disputed and not considered fair and free by the United Nations. Subsequently, on 18 March 2014, Russian President Vladimir Putin along

with leaders from Crimea brought forth a bill which proclaimed the annexation of the peninsula into Russia. As a response by the European Union, in June 2014, the EU and Ukraine signed an Association Agreement that constituted a new state in the development of EU-Ukraine contractual relations, aiming at political association and economic integration. This agreement was centred around seven core titles - Political Cooperation And Foreign And Security Policy, Trade And Trade Relations, Economic And Sector Cooperation, Financial Cooperation With Anti Fund Fraud Provisions, and other General Including Institutional Final provisions.²⁰ NATO and Ukraine signed a Comprehensive Assistance Package (CAP) with the aim of providing Ukraine with practical support, in July 2016 at the Warsaw Summit.²¹ In April 2021, Russia announced the start of mass military drills which raised tensions with Ukraine about the risk of renewed fighting. Tensions started to rise throughout 2021 and ultimately, on 24 February 2022, Russia declared a full-scale invasion of Ukraine.²²

Impact on NATO's defence spending

The invasion has had a significant effect on NATO members' defence spending. In accordance with the defence allocation in 2024 published by NATO, total expenditure on defence increased from \$1190 Billion in 2022 to \$1474 Billion in 2024. The defence budget was 943 billion dollars in 2014; this shows that the change in defence expenditure from 2014 to 2022 was the

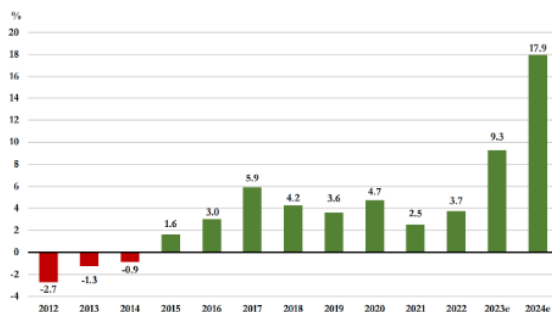
¹⁹ NATO Watch. (2021). *Promoting a more transparent and accountable NATO*. In I. Davis (Ed.), *NATO Watch Observatory* (p. 2) [Journal-article; Online]. https://natowatch.org/sites/default/files/2021-01/observatory_issue_55.pdf

²⁰ EU-Ukraine Association Agreement "Quick Guide to the ... (n.d.-o). https://www.eeas.europa.eu/sites/default/files/071215_eu-ukraine_association_agreement.pdf

²¹ NATO's support to Ukraine. (n.d.-ab). <https://www.congress.gov/116/meeting/house/110331/documents/HMKP-116-JUoo-20191211-SD112.pdf>

²² *Conflict in Ukraine: A timeline (2014 - eve of 2022 invasion)*. (n.d.-h). <https://researchbriefings.files.parliament.uk/documents/CBP-9476/CBP-9476.pdf>

same as from 2022 to 2024. In 2024, the NATO members spent 2.71% of their GDP on defence, which surpassed the 2% goal mark. Poland has the largest allocation of defence spending with 4.12% of GDP (2024), which is a massive increase from 2.23% in 2022. This is a clear indication of how much NATO members have adjusted their defence expenditures to account for the unprecedented war. Sweden, Denmark and Turkey are other countries that increased in net defence expenditure as a share of GDP. Out of all the NATO countries, the United States leads with over 65% in net expenditures. The counteractive measure can be shown by a decreased spending in proportion for the US, from 70 to 65% with no monetary contribution fall yet. This is expected to change even further, as the US is expected to commit to lowering NATO contributions and focusing on their other national interests.²³ This change in budget is not surprising as over the years the United States has consistently encouraged NATO members to increase their proportional share in the defence budget.²⁴



Annual Real Change (in percentage)
SOURCE: NATO

Kosovo War (1998-1999)

Background

The Kosovo region of former Yugoslavia had significant autonomy till the year 1989 when Serbian President Slobodan Milosevic pressured the Kosovo Assembly to surrender their autonomy and then placed them under the direct authority of Belgrade. Attacks initiated by both sides took place till 1998 with the involvement of Serbian Police and the Kosovo Liberation Army. During the months of February and March 1998, a series of raids were conducted by Serbian Special Police units which included attacking towns in the Drenica region of Kosovo, leaving 25 ethnic Albanians dead, other attacks where the ethnic groups had to flee their villages and even houses being burnt. After these attacks, a lot of failed peaceful talks were conducted between the months of March and September between the state actors and mediators. In response to the Serbian government's massive ethnic cleansing and violent persecution of Kosovar Albanians, which was creating a serious humanitarian crisis, NATO decided to intervene and on 24 September 1998, they approved two possible operation plans - one for air strikes and the other one for maintaining a cease-fire agreement if one is reached.²⁵

NATO's intervention

Numerous diplomatic talks were held between 24 September 1998 and 20 March 1999. On 21 March, one last diplomatic effort was made by the international community, sending Ambassador Holbrooke to Belgrade to deliver a

²³Defence expenditure of NATO countries (2014-2024). (n.d.-j).

https://www.nato.int/nato_static_fl2014/assets/pdf/2024/6/pdf/240617-def-exp-2024-en.pdf

²⁴Nato. (2023a, July 11). Defence expenditures and NATO's 2% guideline. NATO.

https://www.nato.int/cps/en/natohq/topics_49198.htm

²⁵Conflict background. jfcnaples.nato.int. (n.d.). <https://jfcnaples.nato.int/kfor/about-us/history/conflict-background>

"final warning" to Milosevic.²⁶ On the other hand, the North Atlantic Council (NAC), had already authorized a broad range of air operations. Upon the breakdown of the final peace talks, NATO, in compliance with the US launched its first airstrike on 24 March 1999 (Operation Allied Force), thus starting the 78-day air war aimed at compelling the government of Yugoslavia and its elected president, Slobodan Milosevic, to halt and reverse the human rights abuses that were being committed by armed Serbs against the ethnic Albanian majority living in Kosovo. The United Nations did not sanction this air campaign but later supported NATO's peace support operation in the region (Resolution 1244 of UNSC).²⁷

FOREIGN POLICY

USA

The end of the Second World War entrenched the USA as an undeniable Superpower. On 4 April 1949, Secretary of State Dean Acheson signed the North Atlantic Treaty.²⁸ The USA recognized the imperative of an economically strong, rearmed and integrated Europe as the key to the prevention of the expansion of the Soviet Union, a confluence of events, like the Berlin Crisis led to the formation of the European-American alliance.²⁹ In 2024 the USA was the leading country in terms of defence expenditure with

\$849 Billion allocated for Defence which was 3.38 percent of their GDP and almost half of the federal discretionary budget.³⁰ The USA has established itself as the most dominant member state of the organisation owing to its significant contributions of troops, resources and finances in NATO, its dominance is further proved by the fact that it dictates the strategic orientation of NATO. The USA has further upheld their international influence, by orchestrating proxy conflicts, fomenting insurgencies, and strategically deploying military aid. The State also recognizes the need for the increase in budget allocated towards defence by other member states as the current benchmark of 2% of the GDP is not nearly enough to ensure safety.

Germany

The Federal Republic of Germany joined NATO on 6 May 1955. Germany joined NATO reasserting its place in the Western European security framework and it came under the "Nuclear Umbrella" of the USA. Germany perceived this as a strategic countermeasure to the Soviet threat, this prompted the Soviet Union and its Eastern Bloc allies to establish the Warsaw Pact in retaliation.^{31,32} Germany allocated approximately \$97 billion toward defence in 2024 which was 2.12% of their GDP. As Europe's largest economy with the lowest debt-to-GDP ratio and as the

²⁶U.S. Department of State. (n.d.). U.S. Department of State. https://1997-2001.state.gov/regions/eur/fs_kosovo_timeline.html

²⁷Nato. (n.d.). Kosovo Air Campaign – Operation Allied Force (March - June 1999). NATO. https://www.nato.int/cps/en/natohq/topics_49602.htm

²⁸Nato. (n.d.). United States and NATO - 1949. NATO. https://www.nato.int/cps/en/natohq/declassified_162350.htm

²⁹Nato. (n.d.). United States and NATO - 1949. NATO. https://www.nato.int/cps/en/natohq/declassified_162350.htm

³⁰Nato. (n.d.). United States and NATO - 1949. NATO. https://www.nato.int/cps/en/natohq/declassified_162350.htm

³¹Defence expenditure of NATO countries (2014-2024). (n.d.). https://www.nato.int/nato_static_fl2014/assets/pdf/2024/6/pdf/240617-def-exp-2024-en.pdf

³²Nato. (n.d.). United States and NATO - 1949. NATO. https://www.nato.int/cps/en/natohq/declassified_162350.htm

country with the second highest expenditure on defence in NATO, Germany serves as one of the pivotal members of NATO. Despite Germany's rising defence budget, its current military readiness remains limited to mere days of sustained conflict, and its operational capacity during conflicts is also constrained as Bundeswehr Undergoes a protracted modernization process. Acknowledging these vulnerabilities, Germany recognizes the necessity and importance of having at least 3.5 % of its economy allotted to Defence.³³ Confronting its strategic shortfalls, Germany is considering increasing its active forces from 181000 to 203000, additionally, a \$100 billion fund was set up to modernize the German military ensuring its armed forces can effectively address national security contingencies.

Türkiye

After the Second World War, the Cold War followed and Türkiye chose to align itself with Western powers in opposition to Soviet expansion, this further intensified Cold War tensions, and the Republic of Türkiye joined NATO on 18 February 1952.³⁴ This led to an escalation in the Cold War. The Republic of Türkiye allocated \$22.7 billion to defence in 2024 surpassing NATO's 2% of GDP goal. Türkiye maintains NATO's second-largest standing army, boasting approximately 402,000 active personnel. Despite its historical commitment, exemplified by deploying thousands of troops alongside the USA in the Korean War and its geostrategic position at the crossroads of Europe and Asia, controlling some of the key vulnerable

maritime areas, due to its limited defence spending Türkiye does not have an equal footing in international influence as its western counterparts anymore. In response to escalating regional security crises in its close neighbours, Türkiye's defence spending reached unprecedented levels, recognizing the fact that NATO's previous 2% goal would be insufficient for ensuring national security in an evolving threat landscape. Türkiye, acknowledging the need for strengthening its defence posture, is aiming to attain a role as a key regional military power.

CONCLUSION

The military and its defence are crucial in determining a nation's security. NATO members must take the responsibility to pay their contribution towards the defence spending. This not only reinforces a nation to embrace its individuality and independence, but it also ensures that a minimum budget benchmark is maintained without jeopardising safety. True safety can only be affirmed once adequate capital is allocated dedicated to the cause. A secure nation does not just confide in its financial funds but also in the knowledge and proper utilisation of the resources. The lack of essential funds creates holes and vulnerabilities in the system and makes it prone to instability. Acknowledging and addressing the issues and acting on them at the earliest assures tranquil and steady governing for the citizens.

³³Defence expenditure of NATO countries (2014-2024). (n.d.).

https://www.nato.int/nato_static_fl2014/assets/pdf/2024/6/pdf/240617-def-exp-2024-en.pdf

³⁴Defence expenditure of NATO countries (2014-2024). (n.d.).

https://www.nato.int/nato_static_fl2014/assets/pdf/2024/6/pdf/240617-def-exp-2024-en.pdf

QUESTIONS A RESOLUTION MUST ANSWER

1. How can NATO help reduce overreliance on a few countries for defence supplies?
2. What policies and regulations can the NATO member states set to ensure that the defence spending is consistent and improved?
3. How should NATO restructure its rapid response forces to improve efficiency in deployment and logistics?
4. How can NATO intervene and resolve the current global threats while maintaining the 2% defence budget expenditure?
5. What should the adequate expenditure on defence be for security during a crisis?